Haymarket Massacre

A labour protest took place on 4 May 1886, at Haymarket Square in Chicago. It began as a peaceful rally in support of workers striking for an eight-hour day and in reaction to the killing of several workers the previous day by the police. An unknown person threw a bomb at the police as they began to disperse the crowd. The bomb blast and ensuing gunfire resulted in the deaths of seven police officers and at least four civilians; scores of others were wounded. To commemorate the Haymarket Affair 1 May 1887 is observed as the Labour Day or May Day or International Workers' Day.

Summary

- Oppressive taxation measures of Britain and the resistance of colonists leading to the outbreak of American War of Independence are narrated.
- The course and outcome of the War along with the significance of Revolution are assessed.
- The woeful conditions of peasantry, the financial bankruptcy of the French government, and the revolutionary ideas articulated by the intellectuals of the time leading to the French Revolution of 1789 are explained.
- The formation of National Assembly and its Declaration of Rights of Man and Citizen are detailed.
- The execution of the French king and the abolition of monarchy, and the work done by the National Convention dominated by the Jacobins are elaborated.
- Revolution in the French-controlled Saint-Domingue followed by revolutions in other Latin American countries like Venezuela, Columbia, Mexico and Brazil are highlighted.
- The essential features and causes of Industrial Revolution of England, the machines invented and the use of steam revolutionising cotton, and iron industries and transport and communication systems are dealt with.
- The Second Industrial Revolution in Western Europe, notably in Germany, and in the US is explored.
- Impact of Industrial Revolution and the incidence of state violence on organised working class movement in England and America are related.

EXERCISE

S2G6N7

I. Choose the correct answer

1. The Europeans who settled first in North America were _____

   (a) Portuguese

   (b) Spanish

   (c) Danish

   (d) English

2. New Amsterdam was renamed as _____

   (a) Washington

   (b) New York

   (c) Chicago

   (d) Amsterdam

3. **Assertion (A):** England passed the Navigation Acts.

   Reason (R): The Act mandated that colonial produce should be exported only in British ships.

   (a) Both A and R are correct, R explains A

   (b) Both A and R are correct, R does not explain A

   (c) A is correct but R is wrong

   (d) A is wrong but R is correct

4. **Assertion (A):** In 1770, England abolished the taxes on products except tea.

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